When statements are executed, the expressions they contain are evaluated right to left. Here are the equivalent expressions of each step as `var_dump($number == 1 + 1)` is evaluated, starting with `1 + 1` becoming `2`:

```
var_dump($number == 1 + 1);
var_dump($number == 2);
var_dump(2 == 2);
var_dump(true);
```

For those of you who are feeling particularly curious (and/or brave) and would like to know the real syntax rules for PHP, the most authoritative place to go is the source code for PHP's parser: https://github.com/php/php-src/blob/master/Zend/zend_language_parser.y … enjoy!

PHP Coding Standards

PHP does not have significant whitespace (any character sequence that represents horizontal or vertical spacing) as part of its syntax rules, and you are free to write all sorts of weird and wonderful things. For example:

```
var_dump(1+1);
var_dump(1    +1)       ;
var_dump    (
    1
    +
      1
 )
   ;
```

```
Output:
int(2)
int(2)
int(2)
```

Each statement above gives the same result, but clearly not of all that code is particularly easy to read. Even diligent programmers with consistent styles will vary in their preferences, and large codebases often end up with a mashup of different approaches to laying out source code. For this reason we have coding standards.